

051. Chapter 4 Verses 20-22

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 4.20

त्यक्त्वा कर्मफलासङ्गं नित्यतृप्तो निराश्रयः ।
कर्मण्यभिप्रवृत्तोऽपि नैव किञ्चित्करोति सः ॥ 20 ॥

tyaktvā karmaphalāsaṅgaṃ
nityatr̥pto nirāśrayaḥ |
karmaṇyabhipravṛtto'pi
naiva kiñcitkaroti saḥ ||

- ◆ **tyaktvā** – having given up; **karma-phala-āsaṅgaṃ** – attachment to the fruit of action;
- ◆ **nitya-tr̥ptaḥ** – ever satisfied; **nirāśrayaḥ** – depending on nothing/refugeless;
- ◆ **karmaṇi** – in action; **abhipravṛttaḥ** – engaged; **api** – even;
- ◆ **na** – not; **eva** – certainly; **kiñcit** – anything; **karoti** – does; **saḥ** – he.

He who has given up attachment to the fruits of work, who is ever content, who does not depend upon anything, though engaged in action does not verily do anything.

VERSE 4.21

निराशीर्यतचित्तात्मा त्यक्तसर्वपरिग्रहः ।
शरीरं केवलं कर्म कुर्वन्नाप्नोति किल्बिषम् ॥ 21 ॥

nirāśīryatacittātmā
tyaktasarvaparigrahaḥ |
śārīraṃ kevalaṃ karma
kurvannāpnoti kilbiṣam ||

- ◆ **nirāśīḥ** – free from hope/expectation; **yata-citta-ātmā** – with mind and self controlled;
- ◆ **tyakta-sarva-parigrahaḥ** – having abandoned all possessions;
- ◆ **śārīram** – relating to the body; **kevalam** – only; **karma** – action;
- ◆ **kurvan** – performing; **na āpnoti** – does not incur; **kilbiṣam** – sin.

He who is free from hope, who is self-controlled, who has abandoned all possessions, though working merely with the body, does not incur sin.

VERSE 4.22

यदृच्छालाभसन्तुष्टो द्वन्द्वातीतो विमत्सरः ।
समः सिद्धावसिद्धौ च कृत्वापि न निबध्यते ॥ 22 ॥

yadṛcchālābhasantuṣṭo
dvandvātīto vimatsarah |
samah siddhāvasiddhau ca
kṛtvāpi na nibadhyate ||

- ◆ **yadṛcchā-lābha-santuṣṭah** – satisfied with whatever comes by chance;
- ◆ **dvandva-atītah** – beyond the pairs of opposites (dualities); **vimatsarah** – free from envy;
- ◆ **samah** – equal/steady; **siddhau-asiddhau** – in success and failure; **ca** – and;
- ◆ **kṛtvā api** – even having acted; **na nibadhyate** – is not bound.

Content with whatsoever he gets without efforts, free from the pairs of opposites, free from malice, balanced in success and failure, though acting, he is not bound.